

Insurance English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: underwriters, claims adjusters, brokers, risk managers, actuarial analysts, policy-service teams, compliance staff, and insurance operations leaders

Focus: An insurance English curriculum for underwriting, claims, policy language, coverage disputes, actuarial assumptions, broker communication, fraud concerns, compliance, and customer escalation.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. Underwriting and Risk Selection

Setting

A broker asks why a profitable account received a restrictive quote.

Speaker	Line
Underwriter	Say the risk appetite changed.
Broker	Exposure, loss history, controls, appetite, and pricing adequacy need explanation.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm underwriting, risk appetite, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Underwriter	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short underwriting rationale. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: underwriting, risk appetite.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects risk appetite.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	underwriting
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say the risk appetite changed.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify underwriting and risk appetite against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve underwriting after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A broker asks why a profitable account received a restrictive quote. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the underwriting rationale with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Setting

A client asks whether a new activity is covered.

Speaker	Line
Account manager	Say it should be covered.
Insured client	Policy terms, exclusions, endorsements, facts, and claims review may control.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm policy, endorsement, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short coverage caveat response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: policy, endorsement.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects endorsement.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	policy
C	coverage

Option	Phrase
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say it should be covered.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify policy and endorsement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client asks whether a new activity is covered. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the coverage caveat response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Claims Intake and Reserving

Setting

A policyholder wants immediate payment after submitting photos.

Speaker	Line
Claims adjuster	Promise payment this week.
Policyholder	Coverage, documentation, liability, damages, and reserve review are needed.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm claim, reserve, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Claims adjuster	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short claims intake summary. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: claim, reserve.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects reserve.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	claim
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Promise payment this week.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify claim and reserve against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A policyholder wants immediate payment after submitting photos. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the claims intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Coverage Disputes and Denials

Setting

A claim appears excluded under the policy.

Speaker	Line
Claims manager	Send a short denial letter.
Policyholder	Facts, policy language, legal review, appeal rights, and tone matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm denial, reservation of rights, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Claims manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short denial explanation draft. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: denial, reservation of rights.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice**1. Complete the field language**

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects reservation of rights.

Option	Phrase
A	reservation of rights
B	appeal
C	coverage position
D	denial

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Send a short denial letter.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	We should act now and resolve denial after the result is visible.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify denial and reservation of rights against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A claim appears excluded under the policy. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the denial explanation draft with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Setting

Premiums increase despite no recent losses.

Speaker	Line
Broker	Blame the market.
Risk manager	Loss trends, exposure growth, reinsurance, capacity, and terms need explanation.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm renewal, premium, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Broker	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short renewal meeting brief. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: renewal, premium.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects premium.

Option	Phrase
A	reinsurance
B	renewal
C	premium
D	deductible

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Blame the market.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A renewal meeting brief is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify renewal and premium against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve renewal after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Premiums increase despite no recent losses. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the renewal meeting brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Setting

A claim has inconsistent timing and documents.

Speaker	Line
Claims examiner	Accuse the claimant of fraud.
SIU analyst	Evidence, investigation process, documentation, and legal boundaries matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm fraud indicator, SIU, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Claims examiner	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short SIU referral note. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: fraud indicator, SIU.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects SIU.

Option	Phrase
A	fraud indicator
B	SIU
C	material misrepresentation
D	investigation

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Accuse the claimant of fraud.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve fraud indicator after the result is visible.
B	A SIU referral note is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify fraud indicator and SIU against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A claim has inconsistent timing and documents. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the SIU referral note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Setting

Leadership wants a simple reason for reserve strengthening.

Speaker	Line
Actuary	Say the model says so.

Speaker	Line
Finance executive	Loss development, frequency, severity, assumptions, and confidence ranges need translation.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm loss development, frequency, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Actuary	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short actuarial assumption memo. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: loss development, frequency.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects frequency.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	loss development
C	reserve adequacy
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say the model says so.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify loss development and frequency against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	A actuarial assumption memo is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Leadership wants a simple reason for reserve strengthening. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the actuarial assumption memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Setting

A regulator asks about delayed claim communications.

Speaker	Line
Compliance officer	Say delays were isolated.
Claims director	Market-conduct rules, timelines, evidence, corrective action, and monitoring are needed.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm market conduct, complaint, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Compliance officer	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short market-conduct response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: market conduct, complaint.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects complaint.

Option	Phrase
A	market conduct
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say delays were isolated.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A market-conduct response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

Option	Phrase
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify market conduct and complaint against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve market conduct after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A regulator asks about delayed claim communications. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the market-conduct response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Underwriting and Risk Selection - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. underwriting	'underwriting' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Underwriting and Risk Selection - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify underwriting and risk appetite against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Underwriting and Risk Selection - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the underwriting rationale with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. policy	'policy' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify policy and endorsement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the coverage caveat response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Claims Intake and Reserving - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. claim	'claim' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Claims Intake and Reserving - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify claim and reserve against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Claims Intake and Reserving - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the claims intake summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Coverage Disputes and Denials - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. denial	'denial' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Coverage Disputes and Denials - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify denial and reservation of rights against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Coverage Disputes and Denials - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the denial explanation draft with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Broker and Client Renewal Meetings - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. renewal	'renewal' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Broker and Client Renewal Meetings - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify renewal and premium against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Broker and Client Renewal Meetings - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the renewal meeting brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. fraud indicator	'fraud indicator' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify fraud indicator and SIU against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the SIU referral note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. loss development	'loss development' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify loss development and frequency against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the actuarial assumption memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. market conduct	'market conduct' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify market conduct and complaint against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the market-conduct response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.